

Scope

This Policy addresses the process for developing, issuing and maintaining Cognizant corporate policies and applies to all Cognizant employees, business units and functions worldwide. Employees responsible for writing, updating and distributing corporate-wide policies must comply with this Policy.

Guiding Principles

The purpose of this Policy is to ensure that the Cognizant community has access to well-developed and understandable corporate policies.

A Corporate Policy:

- is a governing principle that directs or restricts actions,
- applies company-wide,
- helps reduce institutional risk and/or ensures compliance with applicable laws and regulations, and
- is approved at the executive level of the company.

A Corporate Policy Statement:

- is an outward-facing statement that communicates Cognizant's stance, principles, and/or commitments on a particular topic,
- may be published for external stakeholders (and employees) and is written in plain language,
- supports transparency and trust by explaining what Cognizant stands for and, where appropriate, the standards it aims to meet, and
- does not typically set detailed internal process requirements; those belong in Corporate Policies and related procedures.
- is approved at the executive level of the company.

Corporate Policy and Corporate Policy Statement Structure
Standard formatting ensures clarity and consistency. Corporate Policies should be written and maintained using [this template](#)

Related Policies and Processes

- [Cognizant's Ethics & Compliance Helpline](#)
- [Global Corporate Policy Web Page](#)
- [Corporate Policy Template](#)
- [Corporate Policy Statement Template](#)
- [Corporate Procedure Template](#)
- [Procedure for Corporate Policy Management](#)
- [Record Retention Policy](#)
- [Whistleblower and Non-Retaliation Policy](#)

while Corporate Policy Statements use [this template](#). They should also comply with the following guidelines:

- **Plain language:** Both document types will consist of brief sentences using plain language that is easy to understand. They should be no more than two pages, in the active tense (at least 80%) and at or below an eighth-grade reading level.
- **Translations:**
 - In addition to English, Corporate Policies must be made available in these eight (8) languages: Chinese (Simplified), French (Canada), French (France), German (Germany), Polish, Portuguese, Japanese, Spanish (Latin America).
 - Translation of Corporate Policy Statements is recommended, but not required.
- **Availability:** The final approved policy/policy statement and translations must be posted on the [Be.Cognizant Global Corporate Policy Page](#).
- **Procedures:** As appropriate, Corporate Policies should link to related procedures, toolkits or training resources to help implement the policy.

Policy Ownership

Owners are responsible for consulting SMEs during drafting, review and approval of the policy, as well as for company-wide implementation having regard to local laws and regulations. Corporate Policy owners must also establish a method to monitor compliance with the policy, make determinations of noncompliance and refer those policy violations to the Chief Ethics & Compliance Officer.

Policy Approval

For either policy type to become effective, each new or significantly revised policy must be approved in writing by the Executive Committee member for the organization owning the policy as well as by Cognizant's Chief Ethics & Compliance Officer.

For a Corporate Policy to be enforced in certain countries, additional approvals (such as bodies of employee representation) may be required. Corporate Policy owners must work with Cognizant HR to ensure any additional approvals are in place prior to announcing a new or significantly revised Corporate Policy.

Policy Communication

Once either policy type is approved and published, it must be effectively communicated to employees. This can be done through several avenues, including:

- All-employee email distribution
- Be.Cognizant
- Leadership town hall meetings

Owners are responsible for assessing the effectiveness of the communication of their policy and making enhancements to their communication of the policy where required.

Policy Maintenance & Retention

Owners must review their policies every year with a formal update being made either where a change in law, regulation or operational reason exists or, at a minimum, no less than every three (3) years, to ensure its continuing suitability, adequacy, and effectiveness. Owners must ensure obsolete policies are appropriately retired and marked accordingly for the avoidance of doubt. The Corporate Policy and Corporate Policy Statement owners are responsible for

following the [Record Retention Policy](#) for current and retired versions of these documents.

Refer to the [Procedure for Corporate Policy Management](#), which outlines specific, step-by-step instructions for Owners to take when revising an existing Corporate Policy or Corporate Policy Statement, or drafting a new one.

Version History

Revision Date	Description of Change
Sep-01-2019	Initial release
Jan-17-2020	Added reference to new Procedure for Corporate Policy Management
Feb-08-2021	Updated template to meet new branding requirements
Apr-13-2023	Updated branding, hyperlinks and owner
Feb-01-2024	Added Polish translation requirement
Jul-16-2025	Added target % for active voice and responsibility to consult SMEs during drafting.
Apr-23-2026	Updated to reference requirements for both Corporate Policies and Corporate Policy Statements

Policy Control Information

Policy Name: Corporate Policy Management Policy

Revision Date: Apr-23-2026

Policy Owner: [Ethics & Compliance](#)

Department: Ethics & Compliance

Effective Date: Sep-01-2019